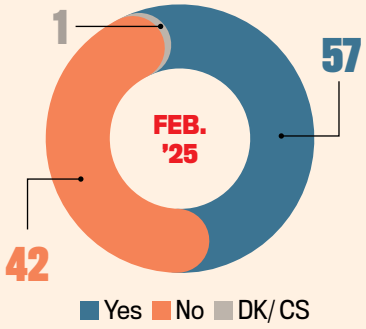
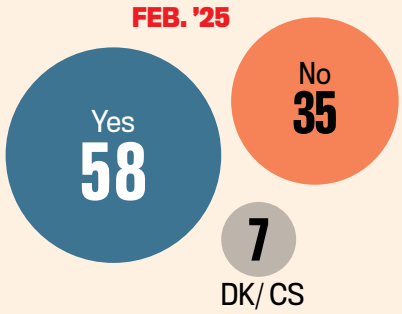


CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

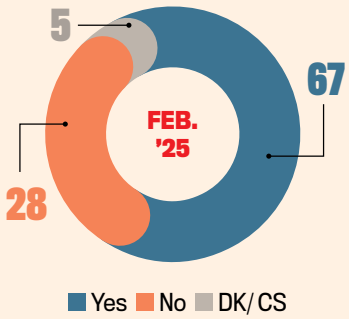
Q. Is RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat justified in asking Indians to have three children to prevent a decline in the country's population?



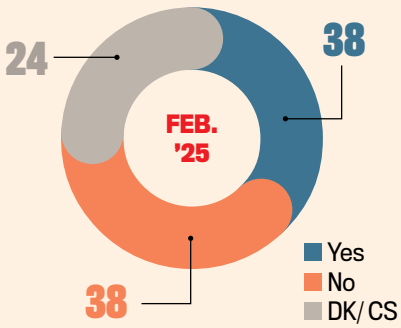
Q. Do you agree with the petitions filed in Indian courts asserting that mosques were historically built above temples?



Q. Do you support Bhagwat's call for an end to temple-mosque disputes?



Q. Do you think it's fine to destroy an existing religious structure if the courts find that it was built on an older structure belonging to a different religion?



DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say; all figures in % and rounded off

The concept of 'Hum Do, Hamare Do', which symbolised planned parenthood and was once central to development initiatives, now appears to be under scrutiny. The latest India Today Mood of the Nation (MOTN) poll reveals that a majority—56.5 per cent—of the respondents agree with Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat's call for families to have three children to prevent a population decline. Notably, that support is highest among those with lower education levels, with 63 per cent endorsing the idea. Regional variations are evident, with as many as 50 per cent of the respondents from the East opposing the proposition.

Bhagwat's call for an end to temple-mosque disputes finds significant backing too, with 67 per cent supporting it. But the survey also highlights strong support—57.9 per cent—for litigations asserting that mosques were historically built over temples. At the same time, opinions are evenly split on whether existing religious structures should be dismantled if courts confirm such claims, with 38 per cent on each side. Further polarising the debate is the government's proposal to reclaim land owned by Waqf boards. While 56 per cent of the Muslim respondents oppose the move, it finds the highest support—78 per cent—among Other Backward Classes (OBCs).

The idea of 'One Nation, One Poll' continues to garner strong support, with 66.8 per cent backing it. However, there's a 5.6 percentage point drop from the findings of the previous MOTN poll in August 2024. Despite some states conducting caste-based surveys, Telangana being the most recent, national support for a pan-India count has also dropped to 69.3 per cent from 73.8 per cent six months ago. The strongest backing comes from Scheduled Castes (77 per cent), Scheduled Tribes (75 per cent) and OBCs (71 per cent), while elite-caste respondents show comparatively lower support at 62 per cent. On the other hand, a nationwide Uniform Civil Code (UCC)—rolled out